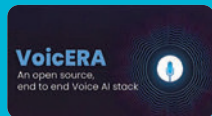


What is VoicERA, with 700+ Indian dialects supported



This open-source, end-to-end Voice AI stack is designed to serve as a national execution layer, moving India beyond

simple text translation and into a future where the primary interface for technology is the human voice. By specifically targeting the nuances of over 700 dialects, the infrastructure aims to bridge the digital divide for hundreds of millions of Indians who can only speak their local dialect. tinyurl.com/4c4de6zm

From factories to bazaars: Skilling India's workforce for AI



At India AI Impact Summit, the session titled "AI and the future of skilling" sounded, on the surface, like the usual education panel: degrees vs skills, disruption vs continuity, and a friendly dose of optimism.

The panellists were not just talking about AI as a teaching aid. They were sketching a new operating system for skilling, one that tries to do three hard things at the same time: personalise learning at population scale, keep curricula fresh, and reduce the cost of trust. tinyurl.com/uhc9695c

AI's real impact lies beyond tech

MIT's Ramesh Raskar said this at India AI Impact Summit

—By Jayesh Shinde

Ramesh Raskar has spent decades thinking about how technology scales across societies. At the India AI Impact Summit 2026, the MIT Media Lab pioneer made it clear that AI must be viewed not as a short-term disruption but as a long-term structural shift that will reshape economies, industries, and individual agency.

"These are such important questions and we cannot solve them overnight... these questions have persisted through different technological revolution and different diffusions," Raskar said, while speaking about the impact of AI at the India AI Impact Summit 2026.

"So I think it's important to take a kind of a slightly longer term view," Raskar emphasised.

That long-term framing runs counter to the current obsession with GenAI's daily breakthroughs and missteps. From hallucinations to misinformation, public discourse has been dominated by what AI gets wrong today. But Raskar's argument is that focusing too narrowly on present imperfections risks missing the broader picture.

"I would encourage you to not get too focused on what's happening right now," Raskar said. "It will be almost like talking about the weather. There's not much you can do, because there are enough forces out there that will go and solve those problems."

In his view, many of the current shortcomings of large language models



are simply technological problems waiting to be solved. "All these things will be solved in the next year or two... if it's a technological problem, it'll get solved with technology," he noted, urging policymakers and industry leaders to shift their attention to deeper structural questions instead.

One of those questions is whether AI is genuinely creating new forms of economic opportunity. Raskar pointed to

emerging research suggesting that while adoption is widespread, meaningful livelihood transformation is still nascent.

"Most of that is for caption creation, asking questions, but only 18% said it's actually helping them... getting a new form of livelihood," he said. "It's very easy to start having conversations about what to do now."

Yet for Raskar, the true economic impact of AI lies beyond today's use cases. He reframed GenAI not merely as a social-impact tool but as a massive economic engine poised to transform sectors far beyond tech.

"Because if you think right now, the world GDP is about 100 trillion dollars, out of which only about 5 trillion or less is in IT," he said. "So the remaining 95 trillion is what GenAI is going to impact in an amazing way."

At the heart of Raskar's vision is a deeply democratic idea of AI ownership. Rather than concentrating power in a handful of large platforms, he believes the next phase must enable individuals and communities to build and control their own AI systems.

"Our mission is to see how we can create highly democratized AI," he said. tinyurl.com/yprmkufe